INVOICE

User Manual

Collecting, checking and following up your Gmail invoices

This manual explains how Invoice works and describes every command and setting. It assumes Invoice is installed and signed in to Gmail — if not, start with the Install Guide.

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1. How Invoice works

Each time you run `invoices fetch`, Invoice:

1. **Searches Gmail** for emails that contain one of your keywords in the subject, an attachment name or the message text, that have an attachment, and that it has not handled before.
2. **Downloads the attachments** (PDF, images, XML e-invoices) into your invoices folder, sorted by year and month.
3. **Reads** the vendor, invoice number, date, amount and currency from the document.
4. **Records** each invoice in its register, with the status *unpaid*.
5. **Labels** the email *invoices-processed* in Gmail so it is skipped next time.

You then use the other commands to check the list, correct what was misread, mark invoices as paid, see monthly totals and export everything to a spreadsheet.

Typical routine

```
invoices fetch                  # 1. collect new invoices (e.g. once a week)
invoices list --status unpaid   # 2. see what is left to pay
invoices edit 5 --amount 240    # 3. fix anything misread (marked ?)
invoices pay 2 3                # 4. record payments
invoices export --excel -o 2026.csv --since 2026-01-01   # 5. for your accountant
```

> **Tip.** All commands are typed in a terminal, in the Invoice folder, after activating the environment (see Install Guide, step 3.2). Add `--help` to any command to see its options, e.g. `invoices fetch --help`.

2. Choosing which emails are invoices

The `keywords` list in `config.toml` decides which emails are picked up:

```
keywords = ["Facture", "Facturation", "Invoice"]
search_in = ["subject", "filename", "body"]
```

An email is selected when at least one keyword appears in at least one of the places listed in `search_in`:

Value	Where the keyword is looked for	Example that matches
`"subject"`	The email subject.	Votre **facture** EDF d'octobre
`"filename"`	The names of the attached files.	**Facture**_2026_10.pdf
`"body"`	The message text of the email.	Veuillez trouver ci-joint votre **facture**.

Remove a value to stop searching there; for example `search_in = ["subject", "filename"]` ignores the message text. How words are matched:

- Upper/lower case and accents do not matter: *Facture* also finds *FACTURE* and *facturé*.
- Whole words only: *Facture* does **not** find *Factures* or *Facturation*. List every form you want.
- In file names, `_ - .` separate words: *Facture* finds *edf-facture_2026.pdf*, but not *MaFacture.pdf*.
- Several words are allowed in one entry: `"Avis de paiement"` matches that phrase.
- The sender's name and address are not searched, nor the text *inside* attached PDFs.

> **Important.** Searching the message text finds more invoices, but also more emails that only *mention* an invoice (payment reminders, newsletters, order confirmations with a PDF). Check new imports with `invoices list` and use `invoices ignore`, or exclude a sender with `extra_query`.

Gmail does the first, broad search; Invoice then re-checks every email it gets back and skips those without a keyword in the chosen places (marked `~` in the fetch output).

Fine-tuning the search

Setting	Effect	Example
`require_attachment`	Only emails with an attachment (default true).	`false`
`extra_query`	Extra Gmail search terms added to the search.	`"-from:promo@shop.fr"`
`newer_than`	Only emails younger than this. Empty = no limit.	`"30d"`, `"6m"`, `"2y"`
`query`	Replaces the whole keyword-based search with your own Gmail query (keywords and search_in are then not used).	`"from:edf.fr has:attachment"`

Run `invoices query` after any change to see the resulting search, and paste it into Gmail to check which emails match.

Importing older mail

By default only the last year is searched. For a one-off import of everything:

```
invoices fetch --newer-than ""
```

3. Commands

Command	What it does
`invoices auth`	Sign in to Gmail (or check the sign-in).
`invoices query`	Show the account, invoices folder, keywords, where they are searched and the Gmail search.
`invoices fetch`	Import new invoices from Gmail.
`invoices list`	List invoices in the register.
`invoices show ID`	Show every detail of one invoice.
`invoices edit ID …`	Correct the vendor, number, date, amount, currency or notes.
`invoices pay ID …`	Mark one or more invoices as paid.
`invoices unpay ID …`	Mark invoices as unpaid again.
`invoices ignore ID …`	Mark invoices as not relevant (e.g. a quote, a newsletter).
`invoices summary`	Totals per month and currency.
`invoices export`	Export the register to a CSV file.

`ID` is the number in the first column of `invoices list`. All commands accept `-c FILE` before the command name to use another configuration file, e.g. `invoices -c pro.toml fetch` for a second

mailbox.

Dates are always written **YYYY-MM-DD** (e.g. `2026-11-05`).

3.1 fetch — import new invoices

```
invoices fetch --dry-run
```

```
Searching Gmail: has:attachment {Facture Facturation Invoice …}
    -label:invoices-processed newer_than:1y
  + EDF | 2026-10-14 | 87.40 EUR | facture_4471.pdf
  + Amazon.fr | 2026-11-04 | 129.00 EUR | Invoice-INV-FR-500118.pdf
  - 'Facturation novembre': no matching attachment
  = facture_4471_copie.pdf: already in register
  ~ 'Votre commande': keyword not in subject, filename, body, skipped

5 message(s) matched, 0 already processed, 1 without keyword, 2 invoice(s) added, 1
    duplicate(s), 0 error(s).
```

Mark	Meaning
`+`	New invoice: vendor, date, amount and file name.
`-`	The email matched but had no attachment of a kept type (see extensions).
`=`	This exact file is already in the register (sent twice, reminder email…).
`~`	Gmail returned the email, but no keyword is in the places of search_in (e.g. only in the sender's address). Skipped, not labelled.
`!`	Error on that email; the others are still processed. Run fetch again later.

Option	Effect
`--dry-run`	Show what would be imported; save nothing, label nothing.
`-k WORD`	Use this keyword instead of the configured ones, for this run only. Repeat for several: `-k Facture -k Avoir`.
`--search-in LIST`	Override `search_in` for this run only, e.g. `--search-in subject,filename`.
`--newer-than 30d`	Override `newer_than`; `""` = no limit.
`--limit 20`	Look at no more than 20 emails.
`--query '…'`	Use this Gmail search instead of the generated one.
`--reprocess`	Look again at emails already handled (files already in the register are still skipped).

3.2 list — see the register

```
invoices list --status unpaid
```

```
ID  Date        Vendor           Number         Amount      Status
-------------------------------------------------------------------
5   2026-11-05  Plombier Martin                        ?  unpaid
4   2026-11-04  Amazon EU        INV-FR-500118  129.00 EUR  unpaid
3   2026-11-02  Free Mobile                     19.99 EUR  unpaid
2   2026-10-20  Orange           F0012845521     39.99 EUR  unpaid
```

A `?` means the amount could not be read: correct it with `edit`. When the invoice date is unknown, the date shown is the date the email was received.

Filter	Effect
`--status unpaid|paid|ignored`	Only invoices with this status.
`--vendor edf`	Vendor contains this text (case-insensitive).
`--since 2026-01-01`	Invoice date on or after this day.
`--until 2026-06-30`	Invoice date on or before this day.

Filters can be combined, and work the same with `export`.

3.3 show — all details of one invoice

```
invoices show 2
```

Shows the sender, email subject, file name and **location of the saved file**, and all invoice fields, status, payment date and notes.

3.4 edit — correct an invoice

```
invoices edit 5 --amount 240 --currency EUR --date 2026-11-03 --number 2026-118
invoices edit 5 --vendor "Plomberie Martin" --notes "Fuite cuisine"
```

Options: `--vendor`, `--number`, `--date`, `--amount` (with a dot: `240.50`), `--currency`, `--notes`. Only the options you give are changed.

3.5 pay, unpay, ignore — follow up

```
invoices pay 2 3                # paid today
invoices pay 4 --on 2026-11-06   # paid on a given day
invoices unpay 4                # undo
invoices ignore 7               # not an invoice: hide from unpaid totals
```

3.6 summary — monthly totals

```
invoices summary
```

```
Month     Cur   Count         Total  Missing amount
2026-11   EUR       3        388.99
2026-10   EUR       2        127.39
```

Add `--status unpaid` to total only what is left to pay.

One line per month and currency. *Missing amount* counts invoices of that month whose amount is unknown and therefore not in the total.

3.7 export — to a spreadsheet

```
invoices export --excel -o factures-2026.csv --since 2026-01-01 --until 2026-12-31
```

- `--excel` writes the format Excel expects in French and most European settings (semicolons, decimal comma, accents preserved). Double-click the file to open it. Without `--excel` the file uses commas and decimal points, for LibreOffice, Google Sheets or English-language Excel.
- `-o -` prints to the screen instead of a file.
- The file contains every field, including the path of the saved invoice file.

4. Where your invoices are stored

What	Where	Set by
Invoice files	*invoices_dir*/YYYY/MM/	`invoices_dir`
Register (the list, statuses, notes)	*data_dir*/invoices.db	`data_dir`
Google sign-in	token.json	`token_file`
App identity	credentials.json	`credentials_file`

Files are named **date_vendor_original-name**, for example:

```
~/Documents/Factures/2026/10/2026-10-14_EDF_facture_4471.pdf
```

- The folder is the **invoice date** when it could be read, otherwise the date the email was received.
- If the **same file** arrives twice (identical content), it is saved once.
- Two **different** files with the same name get a short code added to the second name; nothing is overwritten.
- If you change `invoices_dir`, new invoices go to the new folder; files already saved stay where they are and the register still points to them.

> **Tip.** Back up the invoices folder and invoices.db together, e.g. by putting both in a folder synchronised with your cloud storage.

5. How invoice details are read

Invoice reads the text of PDF and XML attachments (or, if there is none, the email itself) and looks for:

Field	How it is found
Vendor	The sender's name (e.g. “EDF” from *EDF <facture@edf.fr>*), or the sender's domain if there is no name.
Amount	The figure after *Net à payer, Montant TTC, Total TTC, Amount due, Balance due, Grand total…*, or the last “Total”. Both 1 234,56 and 1,234.56 are understood.
Currency	€, $, £ or a code (EUR, USD, GBP, CHF…) next to the amount.
Invoice number	The code after *Facture n°, Invoice No, Invoice #, Bill…*, in the document, then the subject.
Invoice date	After *Date de facture, Date d'émission, Invoice date, Issue date, Date*: 14/10/2026, 2026-10-14, 14 octobre 2026, October 14, 2026.

This works well for most invoices from companies, but it is a best guess. **Check new invoices** with `invoices list` and correct with `invoices edit`. In particular:

- **Scanned invoices** (a photo or scan saved as PDF) contain no text, so nothing can be read: amount, number and date stay empty (shown as ?).

- Images (.png, .jpg) are saved but not read.
- The vendor is who *sent* the email: an invoice forwarded by a colleague shows the colleague's name.

6. Configuration reference

All settings live in `config.toml` in the Invoice folder. Text values are written between double quotes; lists between square brackets. Lines starting with # are comments.

Setting	Default	Description
`account`	(empty)	Gmail address to manage. Pre-selected at sign-in; Invoice refuses to run if signed in to another account.
`keywords`	`["Facture", "Facturation", "Invoice"]`	Words that identify an invoice email (chapter 2).
`search_in`	`["subject", "filename", "body"]`	Where keywords are looked for: subject, attachment names, message text.
`require_attachment`	`true`	Only emails with an attachment.
`extra_query`	(empty)	Gmail search terms added to the search.
`query`	(empty)	Full Gmail search replacing the keyword search.
`newer_than`	`"1y"`	Only emails younger than this (d, m, y). Empty = all.
`processed_label`	`"invoices-processed"`	Gmail label added to handled emails, which are then skipped. Empty = no label (Invoice still remembers handled emails in its register).
`invoices_dir`	*data_dir*/files	Folder for the invoice files. ~ = home folder.
`data_dir`	`"data"`	Folder for the register invoices.db.
`extensions`	`[".pdf", ".png", ".jpg", ".jpeg", ".xml"]`	Attachment types kept; others (logos, signatures…) are ignored.
`credentials_file`	`"credentials.json"`	App identity file from Google.
`token_file`	`"token.json"`	Where the Google sign-in is kept.

Relative paths are relative to the folder you run Invoice from (normally the Invoice folder).

Example

```
account = "your.name@gmail.com"
keywords = ["Facture", "Facturation", "Invoice", "Avis d'échéance"]
extra_query = "-from:newsletter@shop.fr"
newer_than = "2y"
invoices_dir = "~/Documents/Factures"
```

7. Privacy and security

- Everything runs on your computer. Invoices, the register and the sign-in token are stored only there; nothing is sent anywhere except requests to Gmail.
- Invoice never sees your Google password: you type it on Google's page only.
- Its Gmail access is limited to reading emails and adding labels. It cannot send emails or delete anything permanently.
- **token.json** gives access to your mailbox: do not share it, e-mail it or put it in a shared folder. If it leaks, revoke access on **myaccount.google.com/permissions**; this does not require changing your password.
- The project's .gitignore keeps credentials.json, token.json, config.toml and the data folder out of git.

8. Questions and answers

An invoice is missing.

Look for it in Gmail with the query printed by `invoices query`. Usually the email contains none of the keywords where `search_in` looks (add one), it has no attachment (e.g. an invoice to download from a website — download it manually), or it is older than `newer_than`. If the email already has the *invoices-processed* label, remove the label in Gmail or use `fetch --reprocess`.

An email that is not an invoice was imported.

Use `invoices ignore ID`. To avoid it in future, exclude the sender with `extra_query`, e.g. `"-from:promo@shop.fr"`.

I want to import an email again.

Remove the *invoices-processed* label from it in Gmail and run `invoices fetch`, or run `invoices fetch --reprocess`.

I have a second Gmail account.

Create a second configuration file (e.g. `pro.toml`) with its own `account`, `token_file` (e.g. `"token-pro.json"`), `data_dir` and `invoices_dir`, then use `invoices -c pro.toml fetch` and so on.

“Quota exceeded … Units per minute per user”.

Gmail limits how many requests one user can make per minute. Invoice paces its requests and, when Gmail still says “too fast”, waits and retries (lines starting with …). If the limit persists it stops cleanly: run `invoices fetch` again a few minutes later; it continues where it stopped, nothing is lost or imported twice. Large first imports may need two or three runs.

The sign-in page opens again.

Normal: while the Google project is in Testing mode, Google ends the sign-in after 7 days. Sign in again; nothing is lost.

Can I open the saved invoice from the list?

`invoices show ID` prints its location (file_path); open it from your file manager. Files are also easy to browse directly in the invoices folder, by year and month.